

# Welcome to ECON 101

## Macroeconomics

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School of Economics  
University of Northern British Columbia

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# Today's Agenda

- Course overview
- Instructor & contact information
- Assessments and grading
- Course policies
- RISE modules
- Student resources
- **Introduction: What is Economics?**
- **Microeconomics vs. Macroeconomics**
- **Key macroeconomic questions**

# About Your Instructor

## Contact Information

- **Instructor:** Muhebullah Karimzada
- **Email:** karimzada@unbc.ca
- **Office:** Room 10-4522

## Teaching Assistant

TBA

## Office Hours

- **Tuesday:** 1:00 pm – 2:30 pm
- **Wednesday:** 11:30 am – 1:00 pm
- **Thursday:** 1:00 pm – 2:00 pm
- Or by appointment

## Lectures

- Mon & Wed
- 10:00 am – 11:20 am
- Room 7-212

# What is This Course About?

## Course Description

This course offers an in-depth understanding of the key concepts, theories, and principles that drive the functioning of modern economies at the **macroeconomic level**.

### Topics explored include:

- Market forces of supply and demand
- National income determination
- Economic growth
- International trade
- Savings and investment
- Unemployment and inflation
- Monetary and banking systems
- Fiscal and monetary policies
- Short-term economic fluctuations

# Required Textbook & Resources

## Required Text

**Macroeconomics**, 4th Canadian Edition  
*Hubbard et al.*

## Additional Resources

- Lecture slides, practice problem sets posted on **Moodle**
- Students are responsible for downloading and saving all course material from Moodle before access is shut off at semester end

## Important

Keep up with the readings *before* each lecture for best results.

# Course Schedule at a Glance

| Week | Dates          | Topic                                                                |
|------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Sep 9          | <b>Introduction to Economics</b>                                     |
| 2    | Sep 14 & 16    | Ch.1 Foundations and Models; Ch.2 Trade-offs & Comparative Advantage |
| 3    | Sep 21 & 23    | Ch.3 Supply and Demand                                               |
| 4    | Sep 28 & 30    | Ch.4 GDP: Measuring Total Production and Income                      |
| 5    | Oct 5 & 7      | Ch.5 Unemployment and Inflation                                      |
| 6    | Oct 14         | Ch.6 Economic Growth, Financial System, Business Cycles              |
| 7    | Oct 19 & 21    | Ch.7 Long-run Economic Growth                                        |
| 8    | Oct 26 & 28    | Ch.8 Aggregate Expenditure and Output                                |
| 9    | Nov 2 & 4      | Ch.9 Aggregate Demand and Supply Analysis                            |
| –    | Nov 9–13       | <i>UNBC Mid-Semester Break</i>                                       |
| 10   | Nov 16 & 18    | Ch.10 Money, Banks, and the Bank of Canada                           |
| 11   | Nov 23 & 25    | Ch.11 Monetary Policy                                                |
| 12   | Nov 30 & Dec 2 | Ch.12 Fiscal Policy                                                  |
| 13   | Dec 6 & 8      | Final Exam Review                                                    |

# Assessments & Grading

## Grade Breakdown

| Assessment                | Weight      | Date    |
|---------------------------|-------------|---------|
| In-class Quizzes (4 of 5) | 10%         | Various |
| Midterm Exam 1            | 25%         | Oct 19  |
| Midterm Exam 2            | 25%         | Nov 18  |
| Final Exam                | 40%         | TBA     |
| <b>Total</b>              | <b>100%</b> |         |

## Quiz Dates

- Quiz 1: Sep 28 (Ch.2–3)
- Quiz 2: Oct 7 (Ch.4)
- Quiz 3: Oct 14 (Ch.5)
- Quiz 4: Oct 28 (Ch.8)
- Quiz 5: Dec 2 (Ch.10–11)

## Bonus

RISE Bonus Modules: up to **+5%**

# Grading Scale

| Letter | GPA  | Percentage |
|--------|------|------------|
| A+     | 4.33 | 90–100%    |
| A      | 4.00 | 85–89.9%   |
| A-     | 3.67 | 80–84.9%   |
| B+     | 3.33 | 77–79.9%   |
| B      | 3.00 | 73–76.9%   |
| B-     | 2.67 | 70–72.9%   |

| Letter | GPA  | Percentage |
|--------|------|------------|
| C+     | 2.33 | 67–69.9%   |
| C      | 2.00 | 63–66.9%   |
| C-     | 1.67 | 60–62.9%   |
| D+     | 1.33 | 57–59.9%   |
| D      | 1.00 | 53–56.9%   |
| F      | 0.00 | 0–49.9%    |

# Important Course Policies

## Quizzes

- Held in last 30 min of lecture
- Top **4 of 5** scores count
- One free pass — missed quiz counts as the free pass
- **No make-up quizzes**

## Midterms

- **No make-up midterms**
- Missed midterm (with documentation): 50% weight → other midterm; 50% → final
- Must write **at least one** midterm

## All Assessments

- Strictly **individual**
- **Closed book**
- Mix of: short answer, analytical, numerical, true/false, MCQ, fill-in-the-blank

## Generative AI Policy

Use of generative AI is **NOT allowed** in this course unless specifically authorized by the instructor.

# RISE Modules

## What is FY RISE?

The First-Year RISE Program helps you develop practical study and learning skills for success at UNBC.

### Required Modules (due Sep 25, 2026)

- Time Management
- Academic Reading
- Effective Studying

**Required to write quizzes and exams.**

### Bonus Modules (due Nov 1, 2026)

- Academic Habits of Mind
- Generative AI in University

**+2.5% per module (max +5%)**

## Already completed a required module?

Email your RISE badge number to [karimzada@unbc.ca](mailto:karimzada@unbc.ca) — no need to redo it.

# Student Resources at UNBC

## Academic Support

- **Academic Success Centre (ASC)** — free tutoring, study skills  
Room 5-139 | [asc@unbc.ca](mailto:asc@unbc.ca)
- **Academic Advising** — course load, degree requirements  
Room 7-702 | [advising@unbc.ca](mailto:advising@unbc.ca)
- **Access Resource Centre (ARC)** — academic accommodations  
[arc@unbc.ca](mailto:arc@unbc.ca)

## Wellbeing & Safety

- **UNBC Counselling Services**  
[wellness@unbc.ca](mailto:wellness@unbc.ca)
- **Crisis Centre Northern BC (24/7)**  
1-888-562-1214
- **UNBC SAFE App** — emergency contacts & safety tips
- **NUGSS Food Bank** — Building 6, open to all students

# What is Economics?

## Definition

**Economics** is the study of how individuals, businesses, governments, and societies make choices to allocate *scarce* resources to satisfy their *unlimited* wants and needs.

- **Scarcity** is the fundamental economic problem — resources are limited, but wants are not
- Every choice involves a **trade-off**: choosing one thing means giving up something else
- The value of the next best alternative forgone is the **opportunity cost**
- Economics helps us understand *how* decisions are made and *what* their consequences are

# Two Branches of Economics

## Microeconomics

Studies the decisions of **individual** agents:

- Households and consumers
- Firms and producers
- Individual markets

*Example: How does a rise in coffee prices affect consumer demand?*

## Macroeconomics

Studies the economy as a **whole**:

- National output (GDP)
- Unemployment rates
- Inflation and price levels
- Government policy

*Example: Why does Canada's unemployment rate rise during a recession?*

**In ECON 101, we focus on Macroeconomics.**

# Why Study Macroeconomics?

- **It affects your daily life** — interest rates on loans, job prospects, prices of goods
- **It shapes government decisions** — taxes, spending, monetary policy
- **It explains news headlines** — recessions, inflation, central bank rate decisions
- **It matters for business** — firms plan hiring, investment, and pricing based on economic conditions
- **It informs your citizenship** — understanding policy debates makes you a more informed voter and participant in society

# Key Macroeconomic Questions

## The Big Questions We Will Answer This Semester

1. What determines the total output and income of an economy?
2. Why do economies grow over time — and why do some grow faster than others?
3. What causes unemployment, and what can be done about it?
4. What causes inflation, and how is it controlled?
5. How do banks and the Bank of Canada influence the economy?
6. What role should government play through fiscal and monetary policy?
7. How are economies around the world connected through trade and finance?

# Positive vs. Normative Economics

## Positive Economics

Describes *what is* — objective statements about the world that can be tested with data.

*“A 1% increase in the unemployment rate reduces GDP growth by approximately 2%.”*  
(Okun's Law)

## Normative Economics

Prescribes *what ought to be* — value judgments about economic outcomes or policies.

*“The government should increase the minimum wage to reduce income inequality.”*

## Key Takeaway

Economists try to be **positive** in their analysis, but policy debates are often **normative**. Knowing the difference matters.

# Economic Models

## What is an Economic Model?

A **model** is a simplified representation of reality used to analyze economic behaviour and make predictions.

- Models *deliberately* leave out details to focus on what matters most
- A map is a good analogy — it simplifies the world but is still useful for navigation
- We will use models involving **graphs**, **equations**, and **tables**
- The **ceteris paribus** assumption (“all else equal”) is central to most models — we change one variable at a time

## Examples We Will Use

Supply & Demand model, GDP expenditure model, AD–AS model, money market model

# What to Expect This Semester

## To Succeed in This Course

- Attend **all lectures** and take notes
- Read the textbook *before* class
- Complete **RISE modules** by Sep 25
- Practice with problem sets on Moodle
- Visit office hours early — don't wait until before exams
- Review material **regularly**, not just before tests

## Upcoming Deadlines

- **Sep 25:** RISE Required Modules due
- **Sep 28:** Quiz 1 (Ch.2–3)
- **Oct 7:** Quiz 2 (Ch.4)
- **Oct 14:** Quiz 3 (Ch.5)
- **Oct 19: Midterm 1**

# Questions?

karimzada@unbc.ca

Office: Room 10-4522

Office Hours: Tue 1–2:30pm · Wed 11:30am–1pm · Thu 1–2pm

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See you Monday, September 14<sup>th</sup>!  
Read Chapters 1 and 2 for next week.